

AvatarFit

Wizard of Oz Session — Facilitator Script

Session duration: ~20 minutes | 4 exercises | HCI Evaluation — Week 1

What Is a Wizard of Oz Session?

In a Wizard of Oz session, the participant believes they are receiving automated real-time feedback from the app. In reality, you (the Wizard) observe their form and deliver feedback manually, as if it were the app speaking.

Goal: Test whether real-time form feedback is understood and useful — before evaluating the full technical implementation.

[Wizard note: The participant must NOT know you are controlling the feedback. Tell them you are testing a voice-feedback prototype.]

Before the Session — Checklist

- Open AvatarFit in Chrome (webcam working, exercise selector visible)
 - Participant stands in front of the camera — you sit slightly behind where you can see them clearly
 - Have this script and the observation sheet ready
 - Tell the participant: "We are testing a prototype that gives real-time voice feedback on your form. Just do the exercises normally."
 - Do NOT mention Wizard of Oz or that feedback is manual
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Introduction — Say This to the Participant (~1 min)

Hi! Thanks for helping me out. We are testing a fitness app that gives real-time feedback on your exercise form. The app will speak to you while you exercise — just try to follow the instructions as best you can and say what you think as you go.

There are no wrong answers — we are testing the app, not you. Ready?

Task 1 — Squat (~4 min)

Say: "Please do a squat — just like you would normally."

Good form — say:

- "Good position. Keep it up."
- "Perfect depth. Well done."
- "Great form — hold that posture."

Corrections — say:

Knees:

- "Bend your knees a little more."
- "Keep your knees above your toes — do not let them cave in."
- "Your left / right knee is collapsing inward — push it out."

Back:

- "Keep your back straight."
- "Chest up — do not lean forward."

Hips:

- "Lower your hips a bit more."
- "Sit back as if there is a chair behind you."

Task 2 — Lunge (~4 min)

Say: "Now please do a lunge — step forward with one leg."

Good form — say:

- "Good lunge position."
- "Nice — keep your torso upright."
- "Perfect depth on that knee."

Corrections — say:

Front knee:

- "Bend your front knee to 90 degrees."
- "Your front knee is going past your toes — step a bit further forward."

Back knee:

- "Lower your back knee closer to the floor."
- "Keep your back leg more controlled going down."

Torso:

- "Stand up straighter — do not lean forward."
 - "Keep your shoulders back and chest up."
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Task 3 — Plank (~4 min)

Say: "Now please get into a plank position — arms straight, body in a straight line. Hold it as long as you can."

Good form — say:

- "Perfect position. Keep holding."
- "Great alignment — back is straight."
- "Good — 10 seconds in. Keep going."

Corrections — say:

Hips:

- "Raise your hips slightly — your body should be a straight line."
- "Lower your hips — do not let them sag."

Arms:

- "Keep your arms straight — do not bend your elbows."
- "Hands directly under your shoulders."

General:

- "Engage your core — do not let your back arch."
- "5 more seconds — you can do it."
- "Target reached — 30 seconds! Great job."

Task 4 — Bicep Curl (~4 min)

Say: "Now please do a bicep curl — you can use a water bottle or any object as a weight, or just mime the movement."

Good form — say:

- "Good curl — full range of motion."
- "Perfect — elbows close to your body."
- "Great speed and control."

Corrections — say:

Elbow position:

- "Keep your elbows close to your sides — do not let them swing forward."
- "Your elbow is moving — try to keep it fixed."

Range of motion:

- "Curl all the way up — bring your hand closer to your shoulder."

→ "Lower your arm fully before curling again."

Shoulder:

→ "Keep your shoulder still — only your forearm should move."

→ "Do not lean back to lift — keep your torso straight."

Post-Task Questions (~3 min)

After all exercises, drop the Wizard persona and ask:

1. Did the feedback make sense to you?
2. Was it always clear what you were supposed to fix?
3. Did you actually change your form based on the feedback?
4. Was there any feedback that confused you or felt wrong?
5. Which exercise did you find the feedback most / least useful for?
6. Would this kind of coaching be useful in a real workout session?

Observation Sheet

Participant ID / initials: **S.P.T ; L.H.M**

Date: **21/05/2026**

Facilitator (Wizard): **Ane Perez**

Time	Exercise	Feedback given / Reaction	Notes
	Squat	S.P.T — At first she was confused and didn't know how to do a squat correctly, but with the app's feedback she was able to learn.	
	Lunge	S.P.T — She felt she should warm up beforehand, as the lunge was causing slight knee discomfort.	
	Plank	S.P.T — She was unsure how long to hold the position and had to look at the screen instead of receiving the feedback by voice.	

	Curl	S.P.T — She did not receive fully clear feedback for this exercise; the curl felt somewhat confusing overall.	
	Squat	L.H.M — It made her go lower and therefore push herself harder.	
	Lunge	L.H.M — She understood the exercise better and it made her put in more effort.	
	Plank	L.H.M — At first she struggled to reach the correct posture, but after the instructions she managed to hold it. The 30-second target motivated her.	
	Curl	L.H.M — It was the most confusing exercise of the four, but she eventually understood how to do it correctly.	

Overall impressions / key quotes:

S.P.T: Found the concept very interesting and useful — like having a personal trainer. Discovered she had been doing some exercises incorrectly for a long time. Would have liked more precision in some of the corrections.

L.H.M: Definitely useful, as the motivational component is very important when working out. The feedback forced her to do the exercises correctly rather than superficially or imprecisely.

Post-Task Responses — S.P.T & L.H.M

Responses recorded after the session (answered in Spanish):

Question	S.P.T	L.H.M
1. Did the feedback make sense to you?	<i>It was very interesting — it works like having a personal trainer. She discovered she had been doing some exercises incorrectly for a long time.</i>	<i>Completely. She found out that there were exercises she had been doing incorrectly all along.</i>
2. Was it always clear what you were supposed to fix?	<i>Not entirely — she would have appreciated slightly more precision in some corrections.</i>	<i>Yes, because everything was based on not extending the movement enough.</i>
3. Did you actually change your form?	<i>Yes, it helped her improve the way she was performing the exercises.</i>	<i>Yes, she was doing it incorrectly before and changed her technique based on the feedback.</i>

based on the feedback?		
4. Was there any feedback that confused you or felt wrong?	No.	No.
5. Which exercise was most / least useful?	Most useful: Lunge (made her extend the movement much further than she normally would). Least useful: Curl (most confusing). The plank needed more motivational cues.	Most useful: Lunge. Least useful: Curl (the most confusing of all four exercises).
6. Would this kind of coaching be useful in a real workout?	Yes, definitely — the motivational component is very important for completing exercises properly.	Yes, because it forces you to do the exercise correctly and not in a superficial or imprecise way.

Session Conclusions & Design Implications

Participants: 2 (S.P.T, L.H.M) | Date: 21/05/2026 | Facilitator: Ane Perez

What worked well

- ✓ **Concept validated:** Both participants found real-time form feedback useful and reported changing their technique based on it.
- ✓ **Lunge feedback:** The most positively received exercise — both participants said it made them extend the movement further than they normally would.
- ✓ **Plank timer:** The 30-second target was motivating for L.H.M; she adjusted her posture to reach it after initial corrections.
- ✓ **Trust in the system:** Neither participant felt any feedback was wrong or confusing in terms of content — they followed all corrections.

Issues found

- ⚠ **Curl is the weakest exercise:** Both participants found the bicep curl confusing. Without a clear reference point (no weight, unfamiliar movement), they struggled to understand what was being corrected.
- ⚠ **Plank needs audio feedback:** S.P.T had to look at the screen to know how long to hold — she expected the app to tell her via voice. Audio cues for the timer are important for this exercise.
- ⚠ **Precision of corrections:** S.P.T felt some corrections could be more specific. Generic feedback like "go lower" worked, but more targeted joint-level cues would help.

Design recommendations

Curl guidance: Add a clearer visual reference for the bicep curl — e.g., a ghost skeleton showing the correct starting position. Consider whether this exercise is the right fourth exercise for the MVP.

Plank audio: Add a spoken countdown or progress cue for the plank timer (e.g., "10 seconds in", "halfway there", "5 more seconds"). Users should not need to look at the screen.

Feedback specificity: Where possible, name the joint: "bend your LEFT knee more" rather than just "bend your knees". The M3 module already tracks left/right joints — this should be surfaced in the feedback text.

Warm-up note: S.P.T mentioned the lunge hurt her knee slightly — a brief warm-up prompt before exercises involving the knee could be a low-effort safety improvement.

Overall assessment

The Wizard of Oz session confirms that the core concept of AvatarFit is valid: users respond positively to real-time form correction and actively improve their technique as a result. The feedback is understood and trusted. The main areas for improvement are the clarity of the curl exercise and the lack of audio cues during the plank. These findings will be used to refine the M3 module before the Think-Aloud pilot test.